



Glossary



ABDOMEN

The rear section of an insect's body.

ANTENNAE

A pair of feelers located near the front of an insect's head.

ARACHNID

An arthropod with eight legs and two body segments, such as spiders, scorpions, and mites.

ARTHROPOD

An invertebrate with jointed legs, a segmented body, and a hard outer skeleton, such as insects, arachnids, and myriapods.

BIOLUMINESCENCE

A chemical reaction that causes an animal to produce light.

CAMOUFLAGE

Colors, patterns, or shapes that help bugs blend into their surroundings.

COCOON

A silk case made by the larvae of many insects in which they pupate (become pupae).

COLONY

A group of animals, all of the same species, which live together.

COMPOUND EYES

Eyes that are made up of lots of tiny lenses. Can be found in insects and some crustaceans.

CRUSTACEAN

A type of arthropod which is usually aquatic and breathes through gills, such as lobsters and shrimp.

EXOSKELETON

A hard, outer skeleton that surrounds an arthropod's body, giving it shape and protection.

GASTROPOD

The biggest group of mollusks, these soft-bodied creatures have tentacles and hundreds of teeth.

HABITAT

The natural home of plants or animals, such as a forest, meadow, or rain forest.

INSECT

An arthropod with three body parts and six legs.

INVERTEBRATE

An animal without a backbone.

LARVA

A young insect that is at the second stage of complete metamorphosis.

METAMORPHOSIS

The process by which an animal changes from its young form to an adult form in stages.

MOLLUSK

A small, soft-bodied invertebrate, such as a slug or snail. Most have shells. The most common mollusks are gastropods.

MYRIAPOD

A type of arthropod with many legs, such as a centipede or millipede.

NECTAR

The sugary liquid made by flowers to attract insects.

NYMPH

An insect which is at an early stage of incomplete metamorphosis.

OXYGEN

A gas in the air that all animals need to live.

PARASITE

An animal that lives on or inside the body of another species, known as the host. It harms the host but rarely kills it.

PEST

A harmful animal that attacks or destroys things, including crops.

POLLEN

The tiny grains that combine with a plant's eggs, so it can make seeds.

POLLINATION

When tiny grains of pollen fertilize female plants in order to produce seeds and grow new plants.

PREDATOR

An animal that hunts other animals for food.

PREY

An animal that is hunted for food by other animals.

PUPA

An insect at the third stage of complete metamorphosis, between larva and adult.

REPRODUCTION

When plants or animals make young.

SCAVENGER

An animal that feeds on dead animals, plants, and garbage.

SPECIES

Groups of animals or plants with shared characteristics.

THORAX

The middle part of an insect's body.

VENOM

A harmful or toxic substance injected by an animal or plant.

VERTEBRATE

An animal with a backbone.